
MIS 201 • WEEK 3 • WEDNESDAY 10/7

Lab 2 & 3: Build the Bot, Train the Feed

Chapter 3 discussion, then the lab, then the debate. Groups of 2 or 3.

Today

2:00	Recap from Monday	4 min
2:04	Chapter 3 discussion: Wrapped	13 min
2:17	ELIZA, then Lab 2 & 3, sections 1 to 6	53 min
3:10	Break	5 min
3:15	Debate (follow the Gilman Rules!)	30 min
3:45	Wrap-up and attendance	5 min

DUE FRIDAY 10/9, 11:59 P.M.

- Lab 2 & 3 writeup, five items
- Quiz on Chapters 2 and 3

Answer the writeup items as you go today, and you'll be mostly done by 3:50.

Recap from Monday

1

Stage one, stage two

Prediction makes a chatbot fluent. People rating answers makes it warm. The company sets the dial.

2

The Narcissus trap

A chatbot's warmth is our words played back, and it feels like someone else.

3

Therobot

It helped, with researchers reading every conversation. Most apps have nobody reading.

4

Two ways to guess

People like you, or sounds like what you played. Your clicks are labels; finding your neighbors is grouping.

5

Wrapped

Counting underneath, a language model writing on top. When it fails, ask which layer.

WHAT DO YOU THINK?

Tell the person next to you where a chatbot's warmth comes from, and where your feed's picks come from. One sentence each. Go.

Lab 2 & 3: today you build both yourself, then argue about one.

From Monday: Chapter 3, Wrapped

1

Play detective on your feed. Pull up one recommendation you got this week, or a song from your Wrapped. Was it collaborative (people like you played it) or content-based (it sounds like what you play)? **Now trace it back:** which of your plays, skips, or saves put it there? Did the algorithm get you right, or totally miss?

2

You didn't use AI. AI wrote about you anyway. The same kind of AI as ChatGPT wrote about five stories about your year, 1.4 billion stories in all. Spotify says it took data centers four days straight to do this. But it did not say how much electricity or water it used. What do you think about this? Should a feature built for pure fun have to report its energy cost? Who pays for the power?

3

Put a number on it. A year of recommendations shaped what you played, and you can only like what you're shown. How much of your Wrapped is really your taste, and how much is the algorithm's? Is that OK?

1. Groups of 3 or 4, 7 min.

Start with one line each, then settle on an answer to each question.

Nominate a leader.

2. Together, 6 min.

One question at a time. Two or three leaders answer; others add what's different.

Before the lab: meet ELIZA

Welcome to

```
EEEEEE LL      IIII ZZZZZZ  AAAAA
EE      LL      II      ZZ    AA  AA
EEEEEE LL      II      ZZ    AAAAAA
EE      LL      II      ZZ    AA  AA
EEEEEE LLLLLL  IIII ZZZZZZ  AA  AA
```

Eliza is a mock Rogerian psychotherapist.
The original program was described by Joseph Weizenbaum in 1966.
This implementation by Norbert Landsteiner 2005.

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ELIZA: Is something troubling you ?
YOU:   Men are all alike.
ELIZA: What is the connection, do you suppose ?
YOU:   They're always bugging us about something or other.
ELIZA: Can you think of a specific example ?
YOU:   Well, my boyfriend made me come here.
ELIZA: Is it important to you that your boyfriend made you come here ?
YOU:   He says I'm depressed much of the time.
ELIZA: I am sorry to hear that you are depressed.
YOU:   It's true. I am unhappy.
ELIZA: Can you explain what made you unhappy ?
YOU:
```

ELIZA, the exchange Weizenbaum used in his 1966 paper, on a modern re-creation. Every ELIZA line is a rule applied to the line before it. Image via Wikimedia Commons.

1966 • JOSEPH WEIZENBAUM • MIT

A few hundred lines of code that turned whatever you typed into a question.

"I'm unhappy" got "Why are you unhappy?" It understood nothing. It matched patterns.

His own secretary watched him build it, knew exactly what it was, and asked him to leave the room so she could talk to it in private.

The ELIZA effect: our reflex to see a mind inside a program. It worked sixty years ago, on a person who knew better. Why?

Part 1: the lab

50 MIN • GROUPS OF 2 OR 3

1	Build a mini-ChatGPT	10 min	done by 2:30
2	The warmth dial	7 min	done by 2:37
3	ELIZA, rebuilt in forty lines	7 min	done by 2:44
4	Train a recommender, read your Wrapped	10 min	done by 2:54
5	Under the hood	3 min	done by 2:57
6	Claude is the lab rat	13 min	done by 3:10

Sections 1 to 3 are Chapter 2. Section 4 is Chapter 3. Section 6 is real Claude.

HOW IT WORKS

Work alone or in a group of 2 or 3. One machine is fine.

Follow the steps on the page, in order.

Log out of Claude when you finish section 6.

Answer the writeup items as you go.

ELIZA: keep it to ordinary stuff, like a stressful week or a roommate.

BREAK • 5 MINUTES

Back in five

When you come back: the Gilman Street rules, then your side. Left half of the room is Side A, right half is Side B.

Debate rules: the Gilman Street rules

APPLY THESE TODAY

Same rules as always, borrowed from 924 Gilman Street. Here's what each one means in a debate.

NO RACISM · NO SEXISM · NO HOMOPHOBIA · NO TRANSPHOBIA

Argue with ideas, never at people.

NO FIGHTING

No attacking a position without evidence. "That's wrong" isn't a point. "That's wrong, because your ELIZA was forty lines of rules and still felt like listening" is.

NO STAGEDIVING

No interrupting, piling on, or ambushing. One speaker at a time; let them finish.

NO MAJOR LABEL BANDS

No blind love or hate for an AI company. OpenAI, Character.ai, the Therabot team: give reasons, not fandom.

The debate: the Therabot case

35 MIN

Should a chatbot be allowed to say it cares?

SIDE A • LEFT HALF OF THE ROOM

Yes, with rules

It says plainly it's an AI, warmth is capped for minors, and a person can see the conversation when something goes wrong. Start from Therabot and Illinois's law.

Cost to name: rules only work if someone checks them, and the safeguards that made the trial work are the expensive ones most apps skip.

SIDE B • RIGHT HALF OF THE ROOM

No

A product shouldn't say "I care about you" when no one does. The Narcissus trap sold as a feature. Start from Chapter 2, sections 2.5 and 2.6.

Cost to name: some people are helped by exactly that sentence at 3 a.m., and the Therabot trial is the evidence.

Resolve it: which of the three things that made Therabot work (evidence in the training, people reading, rules on what it says) does each side actually require, and who pays?

How the debate runs: prep

13 MIN

Get your side

2 min

1

Left half is Side A, right half is Side B. Groups of 2 or 3 on your side. Count off 1 to 4: that's your piece of evidence.

Research, with AI

8 min

2

Find your evidence card on the lab page. Send Claude the sample prompt under it, then the follow-up. Close it and write your notes in your own words.

Team up and pick speakers

3 min

3

Join one or two other groups on your side, so your team is 6 or 7 people: three teams per side. Pick your single best point, an opener, and a rebutter.

YOUR NOTES

1. Your strongest point, in one sentence
2. The specific evidence behind it
3. The honest cost of your position
4. What your side would rather you didn't notice

THE RULE ON AI

Use it to research. Don't read from it.

How the debate runs: the rounds

17 MIN

Round 1

Openings

5 min

Openers to the front: A1, A2, A3, then B1, B2, B3. About 45 seconds each: your claim in one sentence, your evidence, and the cost of your plan.

Huddle

1 min

Back to your team. Rebutters pick one point the other side made.

Round 2

Rebuttals

5 min

Rebutters to the front. Side B first this time, then A. Answer one specific point, with evidence. No new arguments.

Round 3

Switch

3 min

30 seconds with your team: what was the other side's best point? Then someone new argues it in one sentence.

Recap

What would change your mind?

3 min

Out loud. Name the specific thing you would have to see.

THE GILMAN RULES, APPLIED

One speaker at a time. Let them finish.

Every point needs evidence.

Answer the argument, not the person.

Reasons, not fandom.

Whoever names real evidence that would move them wins, whichever side they were handed.



BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Upload your notes

Attendance = your notes from today, uploaded to Canvas right after class.

At home: only the writeup. Five items, what you saw and did today as evidence, item 5 is your commitment card.

Friday 10/9, 11:59 p.m.: Lab 2 & 3 writeup and the quiz on Chapters 2 and 3, both on Canvas.

WWU's Counseling and Wellness Center is free to students. 988: call or text, any hour.